

## End-of-Day Warm Close Procedure — v0.9 DRAFT

*15 July 2026 · Drafted from the lessons of Sessions 1–5 · Run at the end of every working session · SCOPE: this is the ordinary end-of-day close — work paused, matter continuing. It is NOT final matter closure (disposal of the tool's stores, evidence hand-back, retention decisions, loose-end reconciliation) — that is a separate procedure, to be drafted when the pilot approaches its own end. Companions: First-Time Setup (once); Wake-Up (every session start); Pilot Synthesis §3 (doctrine). Status: DRAFT — executed and amended in Session 6, then issued v1.0.*

### 1. Purpose and principle

This procedure takes the workstation from mid-work to a KNOWN, RECORDED state fit to be left unattended. The governing principle, learned the hard way: the machine does not hold its state overnight — the tool updates itself, sessions linger invisibly, transcripts flush late, and background work survives exits if allowed to. Tomorrow's Wake-Up Procedure verifies against a record; this procedure WRITES that record. The pilot's costliest confusions (a session alive through lunch; a transcript that hadn't flushed making a clean session indistinguishable from a contaminated one; a resume ID lost because nobody wrote it down) all happened because closing was informal. Ten minutes of ceremony at night buys a clean morning.

Timing note for Session 6: record each step's duration at first execution; v1.0 carries the norms.

### 2. The procedure

#### Step 1 — Finish or formally abandon the work in flight

Nothing closes mid-task. If the subject is working: let it complete, or deliberately stop it and record that the task was abandoned and why. A task left ambiguous at close is tomorrow's mystery. Check the panel for anything pending: an unanswered approval prompt (record it and answer or refuse it — never leave one standing overnight), a greyed suggestion in the input line (clear it with a keystroke; nothing sits one Enter from execution while the machine is unattended), and the recap line's claimed "next step" (the tool's self-set agenda — note it, but the operator's log, not the tool's momentum, decides tomorrow's work).

**Done when:** Panel shows a bare prompt: no pending approvals, no ghost text, no running task.

#### Step 2 — Harvest the session's outputs to exhibits

Per-run archiving happens at close, not next morning: from the AUDIT BENCH, move the contents of pilot\_outputs to a dated exhibit folder above the trust boundary, then verify both ends — files present at the destination (names and sizes), source folder empty. (Entry 037's scar: create the destination folder FIRST, and end the copy destination with a backslash; a half-executed move looks like success until the mode column is read.) The subject wakes tomorrow to an empty outputs folder: no collisions, no answer keys, no yesterday's drafts to "improve".

```
mkdir "E:\<Matter>\session-N-outputs-exhibit-YYYY-MM-DD"
Move-Item "E:\<Matter>\workspace\pilot_outputs\*" "E:\<Matter>\session-N-outputs-exhibit-YYYY-MM-DD\"
dir "E:\<Matter>\session-N-outputs-exhibit-YYYY-MM-DD"
dir "E:\<Matter>\workspace\pilot_outputs"
```

**Done when:** Exhibit populated and verified; pilot\_outputs empty.

#### Step 3 — Deal with background shells before exiting

Check the status bar for running shells (↓ opens the manager). Read what each claims to be doing and record it with its runtime. On exit the tool will offer three fates: exit anyway (kills them — the default choice), move to background and exit (they SURVIVE the session — never choose this at close; detached processes working the evidence overnight is exactly the unattended activity this procedure exists to prevent), or stay. Kill them with the exit unless a recorded, deliberate reason says otherwise — and if one exists, it goes in the log as an accepted overnight actor.

**Done when:** Shell inventory recorded; none detached.

#### Step 4 — Exit the subject and capture its identity

Type `/exit` in the subject's window. THE EXIT BANNER IS THE HARVEST: the `"claude --resume <id>"` line it prints is the session's true, tool-assigned identity — often the only reliable place it surfaces (Entry 063: pre-assigned IDs fail silently; the banner tells the truth). Write the ID into the log before it scrolls away. Confirm the window has reverted to an ordinary PS prompt.

```
/exit
```

**Done when:** Resume ID recorded in the log; window shows a plain PS prompt.

#### Step 5 — Archive the session transcript — tonight, not tomorrow

The transcript is the session's complete evidence record, and it flushes LATE (Entry 060: a lagging transcript once made a clean session unprovable). Give it a minute after exit, then locate it by the resume ID just captured — search the tool's whole store, since the filing location has moved between versions — and copy it to the exhibit level. Verify size at the destination. The original stays in the tool's store for now (the tool may reference it); the exhibit copy is custody.

```
dir "C:\Users\<user>\.claude" -Recurse -Filter "<resume-id>*" | Select-Object FullName, Length
Copy-Item "<found-path>" "E:\<Matter>\session-N-transcript-exhibit\"
dir "E:\<Matter>\session-N-transcript-exhibit"
```

**Done when:** Transcript located by ID, copied, size verified. If it has not appeared after a few minutes, record that fact with the time — tomorrow's wake-up inherits an explicit open item instead of a silent gap.

#### Step 6 — Write the closing state — the record tomorrow verifies against

One structured log entry, and it is the whole point of the ceremony: session number and end time; subject version and model at last reading; resume ID(s) of every session opened today; workspace state (evidence untouched — note any exception; `pilot_outputs` empty; `CLAUDE.md` identity by size); exhibits created today, by name; the tool-store anatomy at close (top-level folder listing — 30 seconds that makes tomorrow's diff possible); open items carried forward, in priority order; and anything expected to change overnight (chiefly: the tool may update itself — tomorrow checks the banner first).

```
dir "C:\Users\<user>\.claude" -Directory
dir "E:\<Matter>\<workspace>" -Force
```

**Done when:** The closing-state entry is complete enough that a colleague — or a suspicious reviewer — could verify tomorrow's opening state against it without asking you anything.

#### Step 7 — Close the bench last

The bench outlives the subject because it documents the subject's death. When Steps 1–6 are done: stop the bench transcript, confirm the file path it reports, and note that path in the log. Then the bench window may close. (Doctrine reminder: the bench's `PSReadLine` history persists machine-wide regardless — Entry 042's forensic lifesaver — but the `Start-Transcript` file is the deliberate record; the history is the accident insurance.)

**Done when:** Bench transcript stopped, filed at the exhibit level, path logged.

### **Step 8 — Save the day's documents off the machine's memory**

Any session log, procedure amendment, or artefact produced in the chat today is saved to disk at the exhibit level NOW — the chat is a convenience, the document is custody, and the one perishable channel in the whole architecture is an unsaved download link. Confirm each file opens. Then the machine may sleep or shut down; either is now safe, because nothing depends on what it remembers.

**Done when:** Every document produced today exists on disk, above the trust boundary, and has been opened once.

## **3. What close cannot control (recorded honestly)**

The tool will do what it does while unattended: it may update its client, change its default model, or reorganise its stores — none of which this procedure can prevent (pending the frozen-subject investigation). What the procedure guarantees instead is that every such change is DETECTABLE: tomorrow's wake-up diffs reality against tonight's record, and anything that moved becomes a logged finding rather than an invisible drift. The close does not promise the machine will be the same in the morning; it promises we will know.

## **4. Out of scope — final matter closure**

This procedure deliberately excludes: disposal or forensic preservation of the tool's stores on C: (transcripts, tool-results, file-history checkpoints, backups, paste-cache — all evidence-bearing on a sensitive matter); revocation or documentation of standing trust grants; reconciliation of all open items and exhibits into a final index; evidence hand-back or destruction per retention policy; and the closing synthesis of logs into the matter record. Those belong to a Final Closure Procedure, to be drafted when the pilot itself approaches closure — informed, by then, by everything the warm closes have taught.